The Torma Ritual

Toh 1286 · Derge Tengyur

གཏོར་མའི་ཆོ་ག

The Torma Ritual, known in Tibetan as Gtor ma'i cho ga, is a very short ritual manual that survives without a Sanskrit title line or a named author. It explains how to prepare and offer a torma, a ritual cake presented to deities and spirits: the practitioner, visualized as the chosen deity, purifies the torma with the syllables hūṃ, a and oṃ, transforms it into nectar of a hundred supreme tastes, invites the buddhas, bodhisattvas, gurus, Dharma protectors and ḍākinīs, offers the torma to them with a mantra, teaches the Dharma, entrusts the ḍākinīs with activities, and finally asks them to depart. It is Toh 1286 in the Tengyur, where it is found among the tantra commentaries, belonging to the class of brief practical ritual texts that accompany tantric practice.

Herein is contained the Torma Ritual.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

First, in a skull cup or any suitable vessel, set out the first portion of the torma, and pour it in together with the purifying substances. Then meditate on oneself as one's chosen deity, and imagine above the torma, on a seat of a sun maṇḍala, a single dark blue hūṃ. It melts and dissolves into the torma, and one imagines that the substance of the torma is thereby purified.

Then again, upon a red eight-petaled lotus, imagine a single red a. It melts into light and dissolves, and one meditates on the torma as red in color, clear, pure and stainless, endowed with the supreme taste.

Then again, upon a moon maṇḍala, meditate on a single white oṃ. It melts into light and dissolves, and one imagines that the torma becomes white and clear, of the nature of nectar endowed with a hundred supreme tastes.

Then light radiates from the nectar and draws in the nectar of the nonconceptual wisdom of the Tathāgatas' minds and the nectar found in the realm of the gods, and one imagines that these dissolve into it.

Then again light radiates from that very nectar and draws into the sky the buddhas and bodhisattvas together with the holy gurus, and the outer and inner Dharma protectors together with the ḍākinīs. Reciting oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarbadharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā, light radiates

from the torma and touches the tongue of each of them, and one imagines that they are strengthened by the taste of the great bliss of the nectar and savor it.

Then one should teach the Dharma, reciting the passage beginning "Phenomena are like reflections." Entrust the ḍākinīs with whatever activities one wishes. Having asked for their forbearance, request them to depart.

It is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The phrase rendered "together with the purifying substances" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; the reading is tentative. "Strengthened by the taste" renders □□□□□□□□, literally "taste-strength."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.